INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Economics

HOSPITALITY & TOURISM
TEAM DECISION MAKING EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the concept of competition.
2. Identify factors affecting a business's profit.
3. Determine factors affecting business risk.
4. Identify product's/service's competitive advantage.
5. Describe managerial considerations in staffing.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the roles of the assistant general manager and the human resources manager for THE MARIGOLD, a 48-room independent boutique hotel in the historic district of Brookhaven. The owner (judge) wants your team to recommend how THE MARIGOLD should respond to a large competitor opening across the street.

THE MARIGOLD has been open for nine years and is known for its personal service, locally made breakfast and rooftop terrace. It earns most of its business from weekend leisure travelers and small weddings. Its average room rate is $189, it runs about 78% full and its profit last year was $410,000. The hotel employs 31 people, and many have worked there for more than five years.

In six months, a national hotel brand will open a 220-room hotel directly across the street. The new hotel will have a fitness center, a ballroom, a rewards program with millions of members and opening rates as low as $149. It has already begun hiring and is offering front desk and housekeeping staff $3 more per hour than THE MARIGOLD pays. Two of THE MARIGOLD's front desk associates and its head housekeeper have interviewed there. Local business leaders say the new hotel could bring more visitors to the historic district overall.

The owner (judge) wants a plan before the new hotel opens. Specifically, the owner (judge) wants your team to:

- Explain how the new hotel changes the competition THE MARIGOLD faces
- Identify the biggest risks to THE MARIGOLD's profit over the next year
- Identify THE MARIGOLD's competitive advantage and how to protect it
- Recommend how THE MARIGOLD should keep and attract the staff it needs

You will present your recommendations to the owner (judge) in a meeting to take place in the owner's (judge's) office. The owner (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your recommendations and have answered the owner's (judge's) questions, the owner (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. If we match their $149 rate, what happens to our profit?
2. Why would a traveler with a rewards card choose us over the hotel across the street?

Rate the participants' ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the concept of competition.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Identify factors affecting a business's profit.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Determine factors affecting business risk.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Identify product's/service's competitive advantage.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Describe managerial considerations in staffing.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
9.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
12.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	